[Vibe]rations

An app that can feel your mood and send vibrations to energize your vibe

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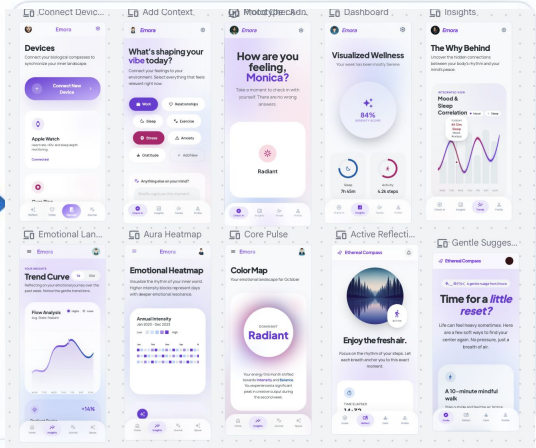
Viberation

A Fair & Scalable Mental Health Support System

PROBLEM

- Rising anxiety/burnout during COVID-like public health disasters crisis periods
- Mental health services become overloaded and difficult to access
- Large gap between rising stress and timely support



WHERE IT WORKS

- Routine, daily life (students, workers, young adults)
- During disaster: COVID surges, severe weather, public emergencies
- Post-disaster recovery: when mental struggles linger even after conditions stabilize

KEY FEATURES

- Visual mood gradient dashboard
- Mood + behavior tracking
- Psychology insights layer (“why” explanations)
- Disaster-aware support mode
- Personalized micro-interventions
- Community support + reach-out shortcuts

HOW IT WORKS

Inputs → Mood check-ins + phone behavior + body signals

↓

Processing → Detect changes like poor sleep, late-night scrolling, reduced movement

↓

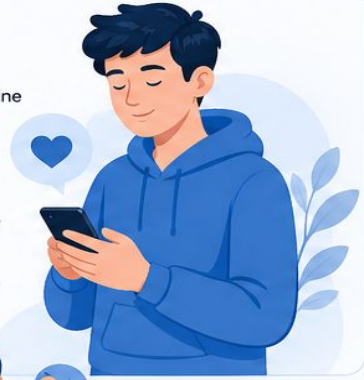
Output → Visual trends, coping suggestions, support hub

FAIRNESS

- Works with low effort input (10-sec check-in)
- Uses existing phone data (no expensive devices required)
- Connects to free public services (e.g., 988, NYC resources)
- Explains insights in plain language (“why” layer)
- Avoids over-reliance on one type of data (e.g., only sleep or only mood)
- Designed for diverse NYC users (students, workers, immigrants)

POTENTIAL IMPACT

- Earlier awareness of mental health decline
- Faster support during overwhelmed crisis periods
- Reduced isolation and delayed recovery
- Better access to support for vulnerable communities



Timely insights. Simple support. Stronger communities.

Problem Statement

During COVID-like public health disasters, mental health struggles rise quickly as people fear infection, loved ones' safety, and sudden disruptions to work, school, and daily stability.

At the same time, support becomes harder to access: services get overloaded, appointments become scarce, and the process of getting help (privacy, time, insurance, paperwork, finding fit) becomes unrealistic when people are already stressed.

This creates a gap where anxiety and burnout escalate without early support, leading to delayed recovery and worse outcomes–especially for families facing financial pressure, language barriers, or limited local support networks.

Who: Users & Stakeholders

Target users:

- NYC young adults (18-35) feeling rising anxiety/burnout during crisis periods
- Students in NYC (undergrad/grad) dealing with isolation + academic pressure
- Workers in high-stress, unstable jobs (service, gig, hourly) with little time/privacy for care
- Immigrant & multilingual households facing extra barriers (language, stigma, navigation)

Other key stakeholders:

- Campus mental health services (Columbia/NYU/CUNY counseling centers)
- NYC public mental health & crisis services (988, OCMH, DOHMH programs)
- Clinics + therapists (in-network/out-of-network providers, community clinics)
- Community orgs (mutual aid, cultural community centers, NGOs)

A visualized mental status

solution and value to users/ stakeholders

Viberations is a visual mental health app for crisis periods and everyday life. Mental health decline usually builds over time through stress, isolation, and small behavior shifts, but most people don't notice it early because there's no clear "readout" like physical health. We propose a visual mental health system, similar to Apple Health, that combines simple daily emotion check-ins with passive signals like sleep, activity, heart rate, screen time, late-night phone use, and social activity changes. On top of raw tracking, the app adds a psychology insights layer that interprets patterns in plain language (e.g., "sleep disruption + late-night scrolling + reduced movement often aligns with rising anxiety/burnout") and shows trends as intuitive colors/gradients over time. During disasters, the app also becomes event-aware by pulling local alerts/news (e.g., public health warnings, severe weather) to provide context for sudden stress spikes and surface timely, localized support steps.

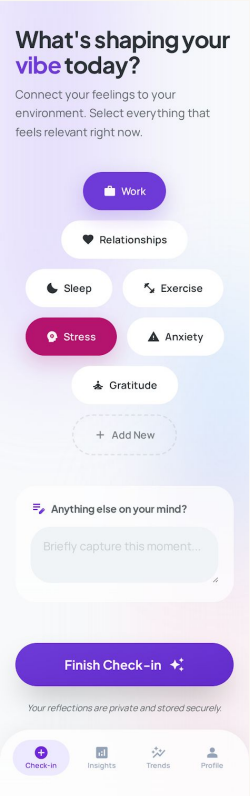
Value: earlier awareness, simpler self-understanding, and faster access to usable support when systems are overwhelmed.

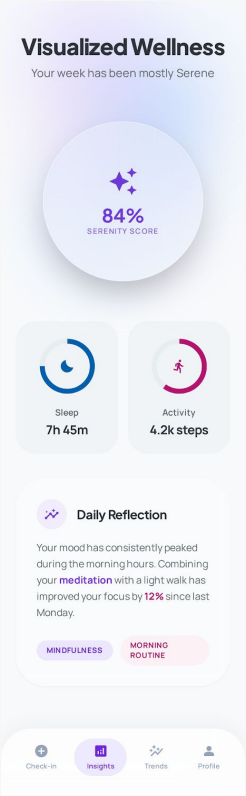
Experience Pre-Disaster

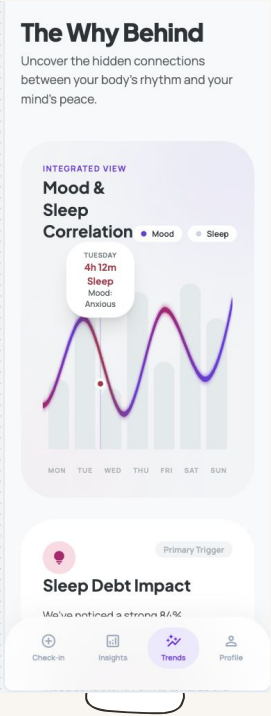
Scenario A: “Busy baseline”
A student/young adult feels “fine” but runs on poor sleep, constant phone use, and stress. They don’t notice gradual burnout until it impacts mood and motivation.

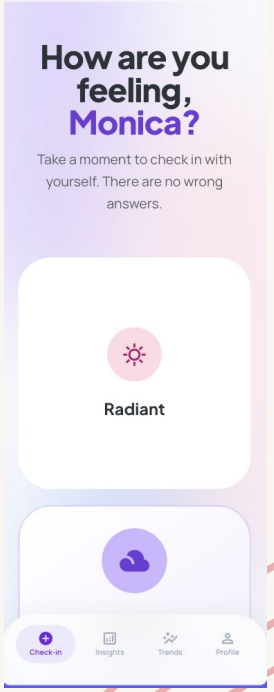
Scenario B: “Low-level anxiety”
Someone has occasional anxious days and social withdrawal, but no clear pattern. They can’t tell if it’s a temporary dip or a real decline.

What Viberations does pre-disaster:
Daily snapshot + weekly trends make small changes visible early, so users build awareness before stress compounds.







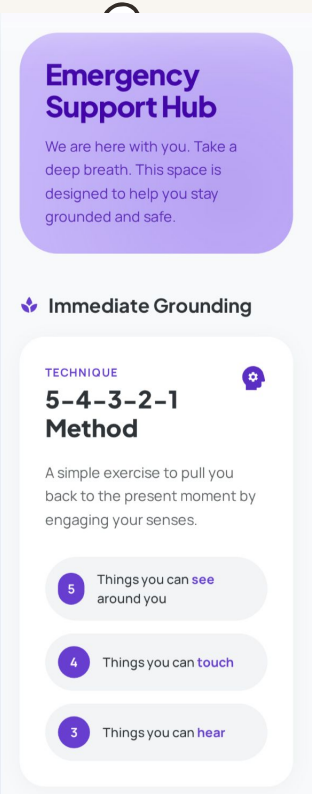


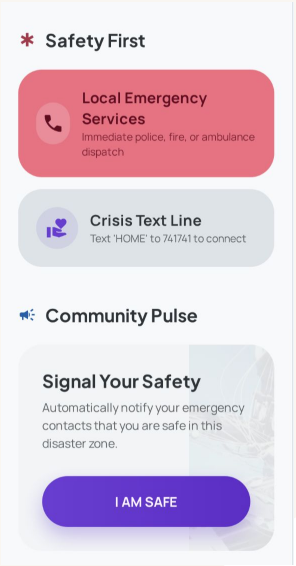
Experience During/Post Disaster

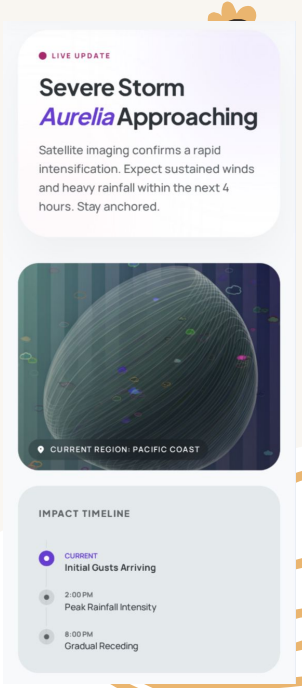
Scenario A: “Fear for loved ones”
A family member gets sick / exposure risk rises. Anxiety spikes, sleep worsens, and the person doomscrolls late at night. They need grounding and clear next steps, not more stress.

Scenario B: “Isolation + routine collapse”
Social life shrinks, days blur, and the person withdraws (fewer messages, less movement). Even when restrictions ease, the withdrawal pattern lingers.

What Viberations does during/post disaster:
It recognizes stress spikes + behavioral shifts, adds disaster context, and surfaces immediate coping steps and local support options when formal care is delayed.







How it works: delivering the experience

Inputs (data):

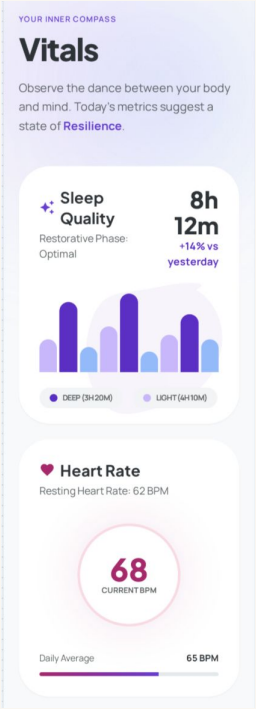
- Body signals: sleep quality/duration, steps/activity, heart rate (if available)
- Phone behavior: screen time, late-night usage, optional social activity signals
- 10-second mood check-in: emoji/slider + optional note

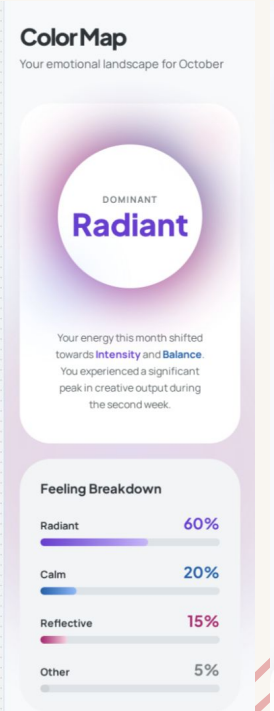
Processing (psychology insights layer):

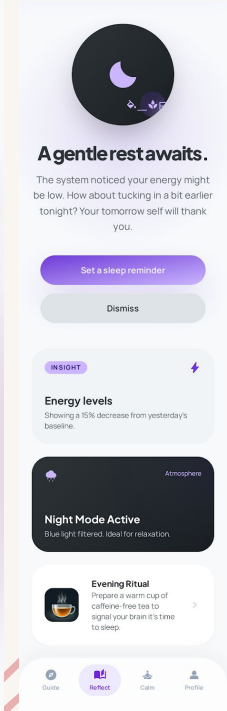
- Change detection: “3-day decline,” “sleep + mood worsening,” “late-night anomaly”
- Lightweight “why” explanations: simple associations (not diagnosis)

Outputs (experience):

- Visual mood trend (colors/gradients) + simple drivers
- Micro-interventions that feel friendly (walk, sleep wind-down, reach out)
- Disaster mode: briefing + resiliency tips + support hub







Ecosystem: where it works + what it connects to

Device + data ecosystem:

- Apple Health / Apple Watch (sleep, activity, heart rate)
- iPhone Screen Time + device usage signals (late-night activity, app patterns)

Support ecosystem (NYC):

- 988 + NYC mental health resources / campus counseling links (trusted pathways)
- Local alerts/news feeds for disasters (public health advisories, severe weather)

Social ecosystem (optional):

- “Reach out” shortcuts to friends/family (text/call templates)
- Private sharing controls (share trend summary with a trusted person if user chooses)

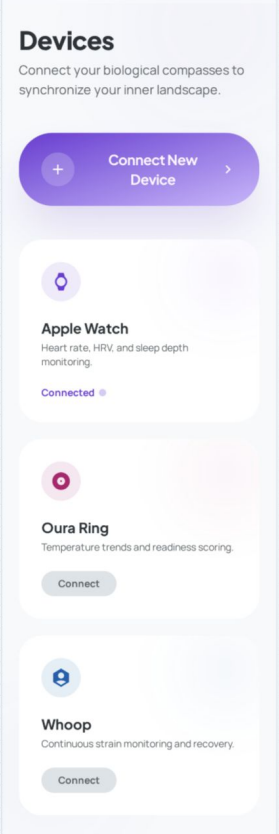


Table of comparisons to alternatives

Method	***Data Type***	***Insights***	***Action***
(Vibe)rations	Mood + behavior + context	Simple why explanation	Micro actions + crisis supprot
Oura Ring	Biometric(sleep, HR)	Data trends only	No direct mental health support
Apple Watch	Activity + health data	Limited interpretation	General health prompt

Fairness: how does the system deliver fairly

1. Access Fairness

- Works with **low effort input** (10-sec check-in)
- Uses **existing phone data** (no expensive devices required)
- Supports users with **limited time, privacy, or resources**
- Connects to **free public services (e.g., 988, NYC resources)**

2. Data & Algorithm Fairness

- Uses **simple, transparent logic** (not black-box diagnosis)
- Explains insights in **plain language ("why" layer)**
- Avoids over-reliance on **one type of data (e.g., only sleep or only mood)**
- Focuses on **patterns over time**, not single-day judgments

3. Cultural & Social Fairness

- Designed for **diverse NYC users (students, workers, immigrants)**
- Reduces barriers from:
  - language
  - stigma
  - mental health literacy
- Avoids "clinical tone" → feels like a **friendly support tool**

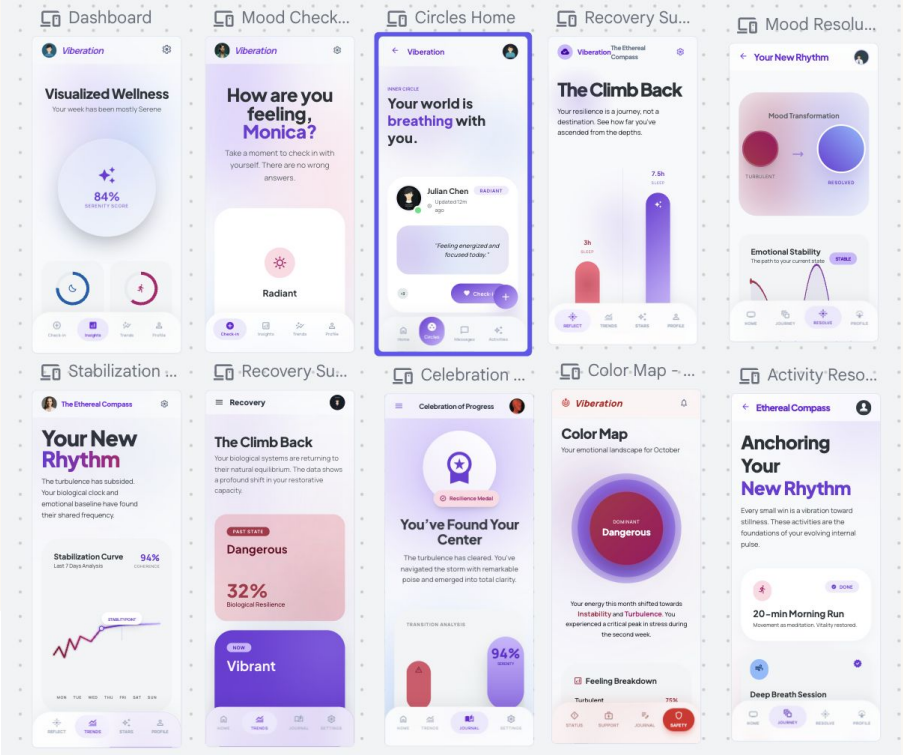
Elevator Pitch

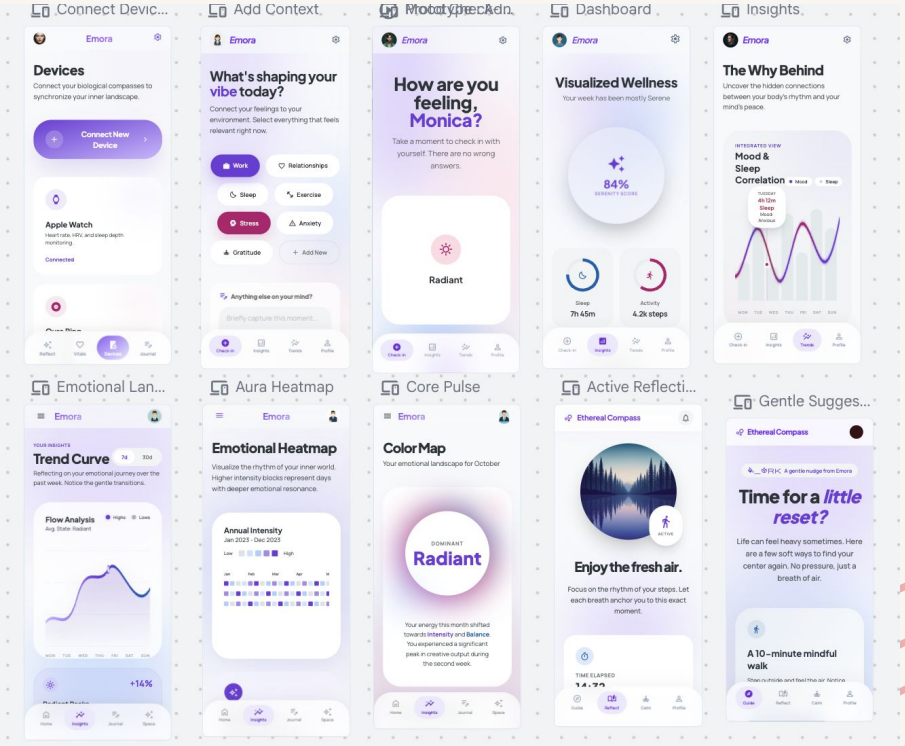
Anxiety, isolation, and burnout where just a few of the prominent mental health crises New York City residents faced during COVID-19. As the cases of deteriorating mental health in the city rose, mental health services simultaneously became harder to access in the wake of disaster. Appointments were delayed, resources were hard to access with rising financial and supply constraints, and importantly, individuals *struggled silently* without early support or detection of deteriorating mental health.

Mental health diseases often develop gradually, but disasters heightens the impact. Stress and anxiety tend to surge quickly during crisis, and even after, the effects linger, as people lack simple ways to recognize early warning signs that they are be struggling.

We propose a visual system that detects early signs of distress through daily emotional wellbeing check-ins, tracking of physical and behavioral patterns, to then provide timely, personalized support and recovery steps. The goal is to help individuals manage mental health challenges at the early stages, before a problem can escalate.

Prototype


Dashboard
Viberation
Visualized Wellness
Your week has been mostly Serene
84%
Mood Check...
How are you feeling, Monica?
Take a moment to check in with yourself. There are no wrong answers.
Radiant
Circles Home
Your world is breathing with you.
Julian Chen
"Feeling energized and focused today."
Recovery Su...
The Climb Back
Your resilience is a journey, not a destination. See how far you've ascended from the depths.
3h
7.5h
Mood Resolu...
Your New Rhythm
Mood Transformation
Emotional Stability
Stabilization ...
The Ethereal Compass
Your New Rhythm
The turbulence has subsided. Your biological clock and emotional baseline have found their shared frequency.
Stabilization Curve
94%
Recovery Su...
Recovery
The Climb Back
Your biological systems are returning to their natural equilibrium. The data shows a profound shift in your restorative capacity.
Dangerous
32%
Biological Resilience
Vibrant
Celebration ...
Celebration of Progress
You've Found Your Center
The turbulence has cleared. You've navigated the storm with remarkable poise and emerged into total clarity.
94%
Color Map - ...
Viberation
Color Map
Your emotional landscape for October
Dangerous
Your energy this month shifted towards Instability and Turbulence. You experienced a critical peak in stress during the second week.
Feeling Breakdown
Activity Reso...
Ethereal Compass
Anchoring Your New Rhythm
Every small win is a vibration toward stillness. These activities are the foundations of your evolving internal pulse.
20-min Morning Run
Movement as meditation. Vitality restored.
Deep Breath Session


Connect Devic...
Emora
Devices
Connect your biological compasses to synchronize your inner landscape.
Connect New Device
Apple Watch
Heart rate, HRV, and sleep depth monitoring.
Connected
Add Context
What's shaping your vibe today?
Connect your feelings to your environment. Select everything that feels relevant right now.
Work
Relationships
Sleep
Exercise
Stress
Anxiety
Gratitude
Add New
Anything else on your mind?
How are you feeling, Monica?
Take a moment to check in with yourself. There are no wrong answers.
Radiant
Dashboard
Visualized Wellness
Your week has been mostly Serene
84%
Sleep
7h 45m
Activity
4.2k steps
Insights
The Why Behind
Uncover the hidden connections between your body's rhythm and your mind's peace.
Mood & Sleep Correlation
Emotional Lan...
Trend Curve
Reflecting on your emotional journey over the past week. Notice the gentle transitions.
Flow Analysis
+14%
Aura Heatmap
Emotional Heatmap
Visualize the rhythm of your inner world. Higher intensity blocks represent days with deeper emotional resonance.
Annual Intensity
Core Pulse
Color Map
Your emotional landscape for October
Radiant
Active Reflecti...
Ethereal Compass
Enjoy the fresh air.
Focus on the rhythm of your steps. Let each breath anchor you to this exact moment.
Gentle Sugges...
Time for a little reset?
Life can feel heavy sometimes. Here are a few soft ways to find your center again. No pressure, just a breath of air.
A 10-minute mindful walk